Prompt 1:

My interest in Financial Engineering development through my academic, entrepreneurial, and military experiences. My undergraduate and graduate studies in computer science provide a strong foundation in programming, mathematics, and analytical problem solving. However, running my own business showed me the real world importance of financial decision making.

As a business owner, I faced challenges involving limited capital, operating expenses, and ineffective marketing strategies. At one point, I nearly ran out of funds because I had underestimated financial risks. By adjusting my strategies and stabilizing the business, I learned the importance of financial planning, risks assessment, and data driven decision making.

My military experience as a 25H in the U.S. Army further reinforced these lessons. Maintaining communication systems and troubleshooting equipment required me to assess risks, prioritize problems under limited resources, and prepare contingency plans. These experiences strengthen my interest in applying technical and analytical skills to risk management.

NYU Tandon's MS in Financial Engineering offers an opportunity to build on my computer science background while developing expertise in mathematical modeling, financial theory, and quantitative risk analysis. I hope to apply skills to complex financial problems and investment decisions.

Prompt 2:

After completing my MS in Financial Engineering at NYU Tandon, I hope to build a career that combines my computer science background with my growing interest in finance. My short-term goal is to work as a Quantitative Risk Analyst at a financial institution. During my first two years, I want to apply my programming and analytical skills to financial data analysis and risk modeling, while gaining a better understanding of financial markets and learning from experienced professionals.

Over the next two years, I hope to take on more responsibilities and become more independent in developing, testing, and improving quantitative models. I am particularly interested in portfolio risk, stress testing, and optimization. I want to strengthen both my technical and financial knowledge so that I can better understand the problems behind the models I develop.

By my fifth year, I hope to grow into a Senior Quantitative Analyst role, working on more challenging projects that involve both quantitative research and development. My goal is to become someone who can not only build models but also understand the financial questions they are meant to answer.

Beyond my career goals, I want to help financial institutions better understand and manage financial risks. My experience running a business and serving in the US Army taught me how overlooked risks can lead to serious consequences. I hope to use what I learn at NYU Tandon to develop reliable models that help institutions identify potential problems early and make better informed financial decisions.